

Zero-dimensional QFT structure of the Alpöge–Mathew Jacobian counterexample, and uniqueness of the defect in the equivariant family $(1, -1, -m)$

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Abstract

The Alpöge–Mathew polynomial map $F : \mathbb{C}^3 \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^3$ (announced July 19, 2026) has constant Jacobian determinant -2 but is not injective, disproving the Jacobian Conjecture in dimensions $n \geq 3$. We study this map, and two neighbouring $\mathbb{C}^*$ -equivariance classes, through the dictionary of zero-dimensional perturbative quantum field theory, in which $F(\varphi) = J$ is a classical field equation with external source and the Bass–Connell–Wright tree expansion is perturbation theory. Our results, all verified by exact symbolic computation in a public repository, are: (i) an explicit structure theorem for the observable algebra $\mathrm{im} F^* \subset \mathbb{C}[x, y, z]$ of the redefined field — $\{1, x, x^2\}$ is a basis over $\mathrm{Frac}(\mathrm{im} F^*)$, membership is decided by a normal form, and x is *not integral* over $\mathrm{im} F^*$, with an exact escape-curve certificate equivalent to non-properness; (ii) an exact reduced Keller identity for the whole weight family $(1, -1, -m)$, reducing the three-dimensional Keller problem to two invariant variables; (iii) for the weight system $(2, -1, -3)$, whose invariant ring is an A_1 cone, a chart-based reduced Keller identity and a *complete* classification of degree-1 equivariant Keller maps (all tame automorphisms), with both the $\mathbb{Z}_2$ and $\mathbb{Z}_3$ stabilizer-jump mechanisms provably empty in the searched boxes; (iv) for the weight system $(1, -1, -3)$, the nearest sibling of the Alpöge–Mathew system, a complete classification of the v -linear Keller class for *all* w -degrees via a Wronskian stratification: every solution is a tame automorphism, the 3:1 orbifold mechanism is empty, and the Alpöge–Mathew mechanism is blocked at $m = 3$ by an exact numerological obstruction — not by a failure to search far enough; (v) the uniqueness theorem for the whole family: for every $m \geq 3$, every Keller map in the v -linear class of $(1, -1, -m)$ is a tame automorphism, so the Alpöge–Mathew map is the *unique* member of its equivariant family within that class. The integrated constraint is $p_1^2 r_1^{m-1} = c q_1^{m+1}$; for $m \geq 4$ the D-strata die by nonconstant factors of the constant κ with *no box needed*, and $m = 2$ escapes exactly where the killing factor u^{m-2} trivializes. One stratum (non-squarefree D'_3) is closed only inside Gröbner boxes ($m \leq 5$) and is stated as an honest gap. The emerging picture is that the non-properness defect is rigidly attached to the $m = 2$ numerology. This is AI-assisted exploratory research and has not been peer reviewed; every claim is labelled exact, box-checked, or open, and each is reproducible from a cited script.

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1 Introduction

1.1 Background

The Jacobian Conjecture (Keller, 1939 [2]) asserted that every polynomial map $F : \mathbb{C}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^n$ with constant nonzero Jacobian determinant (a *Keller map*) is a polynomial automorphism. Despite the degree-reduction theory of Bass–Connell–Wright [3], the formal tree-inversion formulas of Wright [4], and decades of partial results collected in van den Essen’s monograph [5], the conjecture remained open in every dimension $n \geq 2$ until July 19, 2026, when Levent Alpöge

announced (with Akhil Mathew; the map itself was produced by a large language model in response to Mathew’s question) an explicit counterexample in dimension 3 [1]: the map

$$F(x, y, z) = ((1+xy)^3z + y^2(1+xy)(4+3xy), y+3x(1+xy)^2z + 3xy^2(4+3xy), 2x-3x^2y-x^3z) \quad (1)$$

satisfies $\det DF \equiv -2$ yet identifies the three points $(0, 0, -\frac{1}{4})$, $(1, -\frac{3}{2}, \frac{13}{2})$, $(-1, \frac{3}{2}, \frac{13}{2})$, all mapping to $(-\frac{1}{4}, 0, 0)$. Hence the conjecture is false for all $n \geq 3$ (adjoin identity coordinates); the case $n = 2$ remains open. The example was verified by the community and formalized in Lean 4; all claims about it in this paper are independently re-verified in the repository accompanying this paper (`scripts/verify_counterexample.py`).

The Jacobian Conjecture has a well-known reformulation in zero-dimensional perturbative quantum field theory, made precise by Abdesselam [6] on the basis of the tree formulas of [3, 4] and the constructive combinatorics of Abdesselam–Rivasseau [7]: $F(\varphi) = J$ is the classical field equation of a three-component scalar model in $D = 0$ spacetime dimensions with external source J ; the linearization $DF(0)$ is the inverse propagator; the nonlinear monomials of F are interaction vertices; and the perturbative inversion $\varphi(J)$ is exactly the sum over rooted tree Feynman graphs. Constant Jacobian determinant means all loop corrections are field-independent constants: the theory looks free at loop level. A genuine counterexample therefore provides, for the first time, an exactly solvable toy model in which perturbation theory is well defined at every order, loop corrections are trivial, and the theory still fails globally.

1.2 Contents and main results

This paper condenses, into a self-contained account, the exact-structure results obtained in the public repository

<https://github.com/hcab14/JacobianConjectureQFT>

about the Alpöge–Mathew map and its two nearest $\mathbb{C}^*$ -equivariance siblings. The main results are:

- **Section 2** sets up the $D = 0$ QFT dictionary for the map (1): the first-order (conjugate-field) action, the $\mathbb{C}^*$ -grading with source weights $(1, -1, -2)$, the escape locus $\{p = 0\}$ (the non-properness set), and the reduction of $\det DF$ to the two-dimensional invariant plane.
- **Section 3** gives the exact structure of the observable algebra $\text{im } F^*$: $\mathbb{C}(x, y, z)$ is free with basis $\{1, x, x^2\}$ over the fraction field of $\text{im } F^*$, every polynomial observable has a unique computable normal form $c_0(F) + c_1(F)x + c_2(F)x^2$, and x is *not integral* over $\text{im } F^*$ — an exact escape-curve certificate showing that no finite-module refinement is possible (Theorems 3.1, 3.2).
- **Section 4** states the exact reduced Keller identity for the whole weight family $(1, -1, -m)$: $\det DF = \det M$ and $R^m \det M = J_2(PR^m, QR)$, reducing the 3D Keller problem to two variables (Proposition 4.1).
- **Section 5** treats the weight system $(2, -1, -3)$, whose invariant ring is an A_1 quadric cone: a chart-based reduced Keller identity, a complete classification of the degree-1 Keller box (two families of tame automorphisms, Theorem 5.1), provable emptiness of the $\mathbb{Z}_2$ and $\mathbb{Z}_3$ stabilizer-jump mechanisms in two boxes, and an honest account of the computational wall met by the degree-2 box.

- **Section 6** classifies the v -linear class of $(1, -1, -3)$ for all w -degrees by a Wronskian stratification (Theorem 6.2): every Keller map is a tame automorphism; the 3:1 mechanism is empty; the Alpöge–Mathew mechanism is obstructed at $m = 3$ by an exact numerical incompatibility (Section 6.6). One substratum (D_3 with non-squarefree data) is a Gröbner-box gap (Section 6.4).
- **Section 7** is the headline theorem: the $m = 3$ classification extends uniformly to *every* $m \geq 3$ (Theorem 7.1). For $m \geq 4$ the D-strata are empty with no box at all; Alpöge–Mathew survives at $m = 2$ exactly where the killing factor u^{m-2} trivializes (`scripts/search_11m.py`, `docs/SEARCH_11M.md`).
- **Sections 8 and 9** give the QFT interpretation — the defect is rigidly attached to the $m = 2$ numerology — and the outlook.
- **Section 10** tabulates the scripts that machine-verify every claim, with runtimes.

1.3 Provenance and verification

This paper reports **AI-assisted exploratory research**: it was produced in interactive sessions with AI coding agents (large language model agents wrote and ran the verification scripts), and it has **not been peer reviewed**. The counterexample itself is due to Alpöge and Mathew [1]; this work only studies it. The claims should be read with the following calibration, which the text states case by case:

- *Exact / symbolic results* (the bulk of the paper): every displayed identity and every emptiness claim stated as proved is verified by exact symbolic computation — sympy [12] over $\mathbb{Q}$, and Gröbner-basis certificates computed with msolve [10] and Singular [11] — in the cited scripts of the public repository. “Verified” means the script passes, within the stated scope; the scope lines (often box- or chart-limited) matter and are always given.
- *Numerical results* (e.g. the S_3 monodromy of the three sheets, rigidity continuation): labelled as evidence, not proof.
- *Interpretation* (the QFT and anomaly readings): clearly flagged as such.

Every theorem and proposition below cites the repository script that asserts it (for the main theorem this is `scripts/search_113.py`); Section 10 lists the commands and runtimes needed to reproduce all of them. Corrections and counter-arguments are welcome.

1.4 Notation

Throughout, $F = (F_1, F_2, F_3) : \mathbb{C}^3 \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^3$ is a polynomial map in source coordinates $\varphi = (x, y, z)$ with target (source-of-the-QFT) coordinates $J = (a, b, c)$. DF is the Jacobian matrix and a *Keller map* has $\det DF \equiv \kappa \in \mathbb{C}^\times$. For a weight system $(1, -1, -m)$ we write

$$w = xy, \quad v = x^m z$$

for the generators of the invariant ring, and

$$J_2(A, B) = \partial_w A \partial_v B - \partial_v A \partial_w B$$

for the Jacobian of two functions of (w, v) . Primes denote d/dw . For the weight system $(2, -1, -3)$ the invariants are $u_1 = xy^2$, $u_2 = x^2yz$, $u_3 = x^3z^2$ with chart coordinates (t, p, q) as in Section 5. The polynomials

$$p = 27a^2c^2 - 18abc + b^3c - b^2 + 16a, \quad D_0 = 27ac^2 - 9bc + 8$$

are the escape (non-properness) polynomial and the fiber-parametrization discriminant factor of the Alpöge–Mathew map (the symbol p is also used for the chart coordinate u_1 in Section 5 and for lowercase coefficient functions p_0, p_1 in Section 6; the context always disambiguates).

2 The Alpöge–Mathew map as a zero-dimensional QFT

2.1 The counterexample and the dictionary

Direct computation (`scripts/verify_counterexample.py`) confirms $\det DF \equiv -2$ for the map (1) and the triple fiber over $(-\frac{1}{4}, 0, 0)$. Note that all three colliding points are real: the restriction $F : \mathbb{R}^3 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$ is a real polynomial local diffeomorphism with *constant* Jacobian that fails to be injective.

One would like to write $F(\varphi) = J$ as the stationarity condition of an action $S(\varphi)$, but that is impossible: F is a gradient iff DF is symmetric, and here already $\partial F_1/\partial z|_0 = 1 \neq 2 = \partial F_3/\partial x|_0$. The standard remedy [6] is a conjugate (auxiliary) field $\bar{\varphi} = (\bar{x}, \bar{y}, \bar{z})$ and the first-order action

$$S(\bar{\varphi}, \varphi) = \bar{\varphi} \cdot (F(\varphi) - J), \quad Z(J) = \int d^3\bar{\varphi} d^3\varphi e^{-S(\bar{\varphi}, \varphi)},$$

where the $\bar{\varphi}$ -integral localizes $Z(J)$ on $\delta^3(F(\varphi) - J)$. The ghost sector that would produce $\det DF(\varphi)$ is trivial here, contributing only the constant -2 . Splitting $S = S_{\text{free}} + S_{\text{int}}$ with $S_{\text{free}} = \bar{\varphi} \cdot L\varphi - \bar{\varphi} \cdot J$, $L = DF(0)$, the interaction consists of thirteen vertices, each with exactly one $\bar{\varphi}$ -leg, from cubic $(\bar{x}y^2, \bar{y}xz, \bar{z}x^2y)$ to octic $(\bar{x}x^3y^3z)$. The one-point function $\langle \varphi \rangle = G(J)$ is the formal inverse of F : Wick contraction generates precisely the Bass–Connell–Wright–Wright sum over rooted trees [3, 4], with no loop corrections beyond the constant $\det DF = -2$.

Two facts about this expansion, established in the repository and used below only as context, are worth recording. First, the tree series *converges*, with finite nonzero radius; it is the Taylor series of one branch of an explicit degree-3 algebraic function: Gröbner elimination (`scripts/branch_locus.py`) shows that the x -coordinate of any preimage of (a, b, c) satisfies the eliminant cubic

$$px^3 + qx + r = 0, \quad q = 4 - 3bc, \quad r = -2c, \quad (2)$$

with p as in Section 1.4. Second, what fails is *globality*, not summability: on $\{p = 0\}$ the cubic drops degree and a solution sheet escapes to infinity in field space. The set $\{p = 0\}$ is exactly the non-properness set of F in the sense of Jelonek [8], the perturbative vacuum $J = 0$ lies *on* it, and the two non-perturbative sheets over the vacuum sit at infinity, invisible to every order of perturbation theory. Off $\{p = 0\}$ the map is a genuine 3-sheeted covering (being étale, sheets never merge at finite points); its geometric monodromy is the full S_3 (*numerical* evidence, two independent loops; `scripts/monodromy.py`).

2.2 $\mathbb{C}^*$ -equivariance and reduction to the invariant plane

The model is equivariant under the $\mathbb{C}^*$ -action $\lambda.(x, y, z) = (\lambda x, \lambda^{-1}y, \lambda^{-2}z)$: the components of F scale with weights $(-2, -1, 1)$, so the sources (a, b, c) carry weights $(-2, -1, 1)$ and every term of the action has weight 0. The invariant ring of the source action is the *free* polynomial ring $\mathbb{C}[w, v]$ with $w = xy$, $v = x^2z$, and the Alpöge–Mathew map is exactly of the equivariant normal form

$$F = \left(\frac{P(w, v)}{x^2}, \frac{Q(w, v)}{x}, x R(w, v) \right),$$

with

$$P_{\text{AM}} = (1+w)^3v + w^2(1+w)(4+3w), \quad Q_{\text{AM}} = w + 3(1+w)^2v + 3w^2(4+3w), \quad R_{\text{AM}} = 2 - 3w - v.$$

For such maps $\det DF$ descends to a polynomial in (w, v) alone, so the 3D Keller condition is a 2D problem — this is the special case $m = 2$ of Proposition 4.1 below, and it is the engine of the classification results in Sections 5 and 6. The counterexample mechanism is a *stabilizer jump*: the target a -axis (weight -2) has stabilizer $\mathbb{Z}_2$, so a free source orbit mapping into it (a common zero of (Q, R) with $P \neq 0$) is 2:1 — realized for (1) along the explicit curve $\varphi(s) = (\pm s, \mp \frac{3}{2s}, \frac{13}{2s^2})$ with $F(\varphi(s)) = (-\frac{1}{4s^2}, 0, 0)$.

3 The exact structure of the observable algebra $\text{im } F^*$

The pullback $F^* : \mathbb{C}[a, b, c] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}[x, y, z]$, $F^*\mathcal{O} = \mathcal{O} \circ F$, is injective (F is dominant) and not surjective (F is 3-to-1): the polynomial observables of the “redefined field” $F(\varphi)$ form a proper subalgebra. This section makes the cokernel completely explicit. All statements are asserted exactly in `scripts/missing_observables.py` (~ 15 s).

Theorem 3.1 (Field-level structure of $\text{im } F^*$; verified). *Let $K = \mathbb{C}(a, b, c) \hookrightarrow L = \mathbb{C}(x, y, z)$ via F^* . Then:*

1. $L = K(x)$: adjoining the single coordinate x gives everything; y and z are explicit K -rational expressions in x with denominators involving only $D_0(F)$ (the fiber parametrization of the repository, read backwards).
2. $[L : K] = 3$ with basis $\{1, x, x^2\}$: x satisfies the eliminant cubic (2) with coefficients evaluated at F , and the cubic is irreducible over K .
3. Normal form: every polynomial observable $\mathcal{O}(x, y, z)$ is uniquely

$$\mathcal{O} = c_0(F) + c_1(F)x + c_2(F)x^2, \quad c_i \in \mathbb{C}(a, b, c),$$

computable by one polynomial division (reduction mod the eliminant); the denominators of the c_i are powers of D_0 times powers of the escape polynomial p .

4. Membership criterion: $\mathcal{O}$ is a function of the redefined field alone iff $c_1 = c_2 = 0$. The missing observables are, at field level, the free module generated by $\{x, x^2\}$ over $\text{im } F^*$ — precisely the two sheet-separating degrees of freedom of the degree-3 covering.

Worked examples (asserted): $F_1 \mapsto (a, 0, 0)$; $F_3^2 - 5F_2 \mapsto (c^2 - 5b, 0, 0)$; and

$$y = \frac{81abc^2 - 72ac - 15b^2c + 16b}{2D_0} + \frac{3p}{D_0}x - \frac{3(9ac - b)p}{2D_0}x^2,$$

with a similar expansion for z whose separator coefficients also carry the factor p . The escape polynomial appears *verbatim* in the separator coefficients: the amount by which a coordinate fails to be an observable of $F(\varphi)$ is proportional to the non-properness polynomial.

Theorem 3.2 (No finite-module version; exact escape certificate; verified). *x is not integral over $\text{im } F^*$. Along the curve*

$$\varphi(T) = \left(T, y_0, \frac{2T - 3T^2y_0 - c_3}{T^3} \right),$$

the source escapes ($x = T \rightarrow \infty$) while $F(\varphi(T))$ converges to the finite target $(y_0^2(1 - c_3y_0), y_0(4 - 3c_3y_0), c_3)$, which lies exactly on the wall $\{p = 0\}$ (this is a rational parametrization of the Jelonek set by (y_0, c_3)). An integral element must stay bounded when its coefficients do, so no monic relation for x over $\mathbb{C}[a, b, c]$ exists; in particular $\mathbb{C}[x, y, z]$ is not a finite module over $\text{im } F^$.*

Remark 3.3. This is the ring-theoretic face of non-properness: for these dominant Keller maps, finite module $\Leftrightarrow$ proper map, and a proper Keller map would be injective. Every counterexample to the Jacobian Conjecture must therefore exhibit this infinite-module pathology; the normal form of Theorem 3.1 is the best possible structure statement.

Membership can be decided cheaply: field-level membership by the normal form (one division); strict polynomial membership by the standard tag-variable Gröbner test; and for the coordinates themselves a single exact fiber computation suffices — the fiber over $F(1, 2, 3)$ consists of three points whose x -, y - and z -coordinates are pairwise distinct (verified), and any element of $\text{im } F^*$ is constant on fibers.

QFT reading. The observable algebra of the redefined field has corank 2 as a module inside the full observable algebra, with explicit generators x, x^2 for the quotient: the operators that distinguish the three classical vacua over a source J . They are exactly the observables that perturbation theory around one vacuum constructs as algebraic functions of J (branches of the cubic) and that no polynomial function of J represents; they cease to exist as finite quantities exactly where $p = 0$. “Which observables are missing” and “where does the theory degenerate” have the same answer.

4 The reduced Keller identity for the family $(1, -1, -m)$

The reduction used for the Alpöge–Mathew system in Section 2.2 holds uniformly in the weight family $(1, -1, -m)$. It is proved as an identity of differential polynomials (sympy applied to undetermined functions — not a spot check) in `scripts/reduction_113.py`, module `jqcft/reduction_w.py`.

Proposition 4.1 (Reduced Keller identity; verified for $m \leq 4$, uniform proof). *Fix $m \geq 1$ and the source action $\lambda.(x, y, z) = (\lambda x, \lambda^{-1}y, \lambda^{-m}z)$, with free invariant ring $\mathbb{C}[w, v]$, $w = xy$,*

$v = x^m z$. Invertibility of $DF(0)$ forces the component weights of an equivariant F to be a permutation of $(-m, -1, 1)$; fixing the order,

$$F = \left(\frac{P(w, v)}{x^m}, \frac{Q(w, v)}{x}, x R(w, v) \right).$$

Then:

1. F is a polynomial map iff every monomial $w^j v^k$ of P satisfies $j + mk \geq m$ and every monomial of Q satisfies $j + mk \geq 1$ (R is unconstrained);
2. $\det DF$ is a function of (w, v) alone:

$$\det DF = \det M = -m P J_2(Q, R) + Q J_2(P, R) + R J_2(P, Q),$$

where M is the 3×3 matrix with rows $(d_i S_i, \partial_w S_i, \partial_v S_i)$, $(S_1, S_2, S_3) = (P, Q, R)$, $d = (-m, -1, 1)$;

3. compact form: $R^m \det M = J_2(P R^m, Q R)$ identically, so

$$\det DF \equiv \kappa \iff J_2(P R^m, Q R) = \kappa R^m.$$

The 3D Keller problem for this equivariance class is therefore a 2D problem, for every m .

Proof sketch. In the coordinates (x, w, v) one has $\det \partial(x, w, v) / \partial(x, y, z) = x^{m+1}$, and the equivariant form gives $\det DF = x^{\sum d_i + m + 1} \det M = \det M$ since $\sum d_i = -m$. The script proves the identity (and the compact form) with P, Q, R undetermined functions for $m = 1, 2, 3, 4$; the chain-rule computation is uniform in m . Consistency at $m = 2$: the machinery reproduces the known reduction on the Alpöge–Mathew map, with residual 0 at $\kappa = -2$. The polynomiality box is verified in both directions on exhaustive monomial boxes at $m = 3$. $\square$

Two gauge structures accompany the reduction and are used throughout Section 6. First, $DF(0) = \text{antidiag}(p_1(0), q'_0(0), r_0(0))$, where p_1 is the v -coefficient of P , etc.; target scalings normalize $p_1(0) = q'_0(0) = r_0(0) = 1$, hence (at $m = 3$) $\kappa = \det DF(0) = -1$. Second, the source shears $z \mapsto z + y^m h(xy)$ act on the invariants as $v \mapsto v + w^m h(w)$ — the box-preserving part of the full v -shear group $v \mapsto v + h(w)$, $h \in \mathbb{C}[w]$ arbitrary, under which $\det M$ is exactly invariant (asserted). The full v -shear group is an analysis tool: one solves modulo shears first and imposes the polynomiality box last.

5 The weight system $(2, -1, -3)$: A_1 -cone reduction and degree-1 classification

All claims in this section are proved by assertion in `scripts/search_213.py` and its module `jqcft/reduction_213.py`; the repository document `docs/SEARCH_213.md` gives the full account.

5.1 Why this weight system

For $\lambda.(x, y, z) = (\lambda^2 x, \lambda^{-1} y, \lambda^{-3} z)$ the orbit space has *two* orbifold strata instead of the single one of the Alpgöge–Mathew system: the target x -axis has stabilizer $\mathbb{Z}_2$ (the same 2:1 mechanism that powers the counterexample) and the target z -axis has stabilizer $\mathbb{Z}_3$ (a free orbit mapping into it would be 3:1 — cube-root escape and a $\mathbb{Z}_3$ monodromy class, a candidate for a different global-anomaly class). Unlike the $(1, -1, -m)$ family the invariant ring is not free, so the reduction of Proposition 4.1 does not apply and was rebuilt.

5.2 Invariant theory and normal form (exact)

Monomials $x^i y^j z^k$ are invariant iff $2i - j - 3k = 0$; the invariant ring is the A_1 quadric cone

$$R = \mathbb{C}[u_1, u_2, u_3]/(u_2^2 - u_1 u_3), \quad u_1 = xy^2, \quad u_2 = x^2 yz, \quad u_3 = x^3 z^2,$$

verified through a unique normal form for invariant monomials (exhaustively for degree ≤ 12). The spaces of weight- d polynomials are R -modules with verified syzygy-free splittings, e.g. $M_{-1} = yR \oplus xz\mathbb{C}[u_3]$ and $M_{-3} = zR \oplus y^3\mathbb{C}[u_1]$. Invertibility of $DF(0)$ forces the component weights to be a permutation of $(2, -1, -3)$, and every candidate has the normal form

$$F = (x A(u), y B(u) + xz C(u_3), z D(u) + y^3 E(u_1)), \quad DF(0) = \text{diag}(A(0), B(0), D(0)),$$

with no polynomiality side conditions (every polynomial choice of (A, B, C, D, E) assembles to a polynomial map).

5.3 Chart-based reduced Keller identity (exact)

The $\mathbb{C}^*$ -action is free on $\{y \neq 0\}$, and on $\{x \neq 0, y \neq 0\}$ the slice parametrization

$$\Phi(t, p, q) = \left(\frac{p}{t^2}, t, \frac{q t^3}{p^2} \right), \quad t = y, \quad p = u_1, \quad q = u_2,$$

pulls the invariants back to $(p, q, q^2/p)$ — the cone in its chart $u_3 = u_2^2/u_1$. Writing $\tilde{a} = A(p, q, q^2/p)$, $\tilde{b} = B(\cdot) + \frac{q}{p}C(q^2/p)$, $\tilde{e} = \frac{q}{p^2}D(\cdot) + E(p)$, one gets $F \circ \Phi = (p\tilde{a}/t^2, t\tilde{b}, t^3\tilde{e})$ and, by the chain rule,

$$\det DF = \Delta(p, q) = p^2 \left(2p\tilde{a} J_2(\tilde{b}, \tilde{e}) + \tilde{b} J_2(p\tilde{a}, \tilde{e}) - 3\tilde{e} J_2(p\tilde{a}, \tilde{b}) \right), \quad (3)$$

with J_2 the Jacobian in (p, q) : a rational function of the two invariant chart coordinates alone, with denominator a pure power of p . The identity is proved with undetermined functions and re-verified against the raw 3D determinant and against an intrinsic normal-form determinant on the cone. Since Φ parametrizes a dense open set, $\det DF \equiv \kappa$ iff $\text{numer}(\Delta - \kappa) \equiv 0$ in $\mathbb{C}[p, q]$ — a finite, *trilinear* polynomial system (degree ≤ 1 in each of the blocks $A \mid B, C \mid D, E$). Gauge: target scalings set $A(0) = B(0) = D(0) = 1$, $\kappa = 1$; the constant xz -shear sets $C(0) = 0$ (box-preservingly); $E(0)$ cannot be gauged away and is kept as an unknown.

The two stabilizer-jump mechanisms become pointwise conditions: a free orbit over (p_0, q_0) , $p_0 \neq 0$, maps 2:1 onto the target x -axis iff $\tilde{b} = \tilde{e} = 0 \neq \tilde{a}$ there, and 3:1 onto the target z -axis iff $\tilde{a} = \tilde{b} = 0 \neq \tilde{e}$; analogous conditions cover the $y = 0$ stratum, and the $x = 0$ stratum supports no mechanism. Any Keller solution with such a witness would automatically be a counterexample.

5.4 The degree-1 box: complete classification

Theorem 5.1 (Degree-1 classification; exact, box-complete). *In the box A, B, D of degree ≤ 1 in (u_1, u_2, u_3) , $C = c_3 u_3$, $E = e_0 + e_1 u_1$ (canonical, syzygy-free), with the gauge above — 12 unknowns, 20 trilinear equations — the Keller variety is 2-dimensional and decomposes exactly (not just up to closure) as $V(I) = V_1 \cup V_2$:*

1. V_1 (elementary z -shears): $F = (x, y, z + y^3(e_0 + e_1 u_1))$, i.e. $z \mapsto z + y^3 h(xy^2)$;
2. V_2 (w -shears): with $w = xz - \nu y$ and parameters (λ, ν) ,

$$F = (x, y + \lambda x w^3, z + \lambda \nu w^3), \quad w \circ F = w,$$

an elementary shear in the coordinates (x, w, z) .

Both families are tame automorphisms with explicit polynomial inverses (verified by composition) and generic fiber cardinality 1. Moreover all six orbifold-mechanism systems (2:1 and 3:1, at the torus-normalized witness points and on the $y = 0$ stratum) are provably empty (Gröbner basis = [1]).

The completeness proof is exact: six relations have powers inside the ideal I (Gröbner reduction certificates), so they vanish on the whole variety, and the ideal element $c_3 e_1^3 \in I$ splits the variety into $\{c_3 \neq 0\}$ (pinned to V_2), $\{e_1 \neq 0\}$ (pinned to V_1) and $\{c_3 = e_1 = 0\}$ (pinned to V_1 again). The residual 2-torus acts freely on witness points and preserves box and gauge, so the pointwise mechanism checks exhaust all witnesses.

In the enlarged *CE2 box* ($C \in \text{span}\{u_3, u_3^2\}$, $E \in \text{span}\{1, u_1, u_1^2\}$; 14 unknowns, 34 equations) the six mechanism emptiness queries are again all empty (exact, over $\mathbb{Q}$; longest single Gröbner basis ≈ 5 min). A full variety decomposition of CE2 was not attempted, so in that box only the stabilizer-jump mechanisms are excluded — a Keller map could in principle identify two distinct free orbits; ruling that out needs the full decomposition, done only for the degree-1 box. (For Alpöge–Mathew the realized mechanism *is* the stabilizer jump, which motivates prioritizing it.)

5.5 The degree-2 box: an honest wall

The full degree-2 box (29 unknowns, 57 Keller equations plus witness conditions) is **unresolved, not ruled out**, after a serious tooling campaign whose obstruction is now precisely mapped (`scripts/deg2_213_elim.py`):

1. sympy’s Buchberger: no query finishes (> 25 min each, also mod p).
2. msolve F4 [10] (under a 16 GB address-space cap): all six queries exceed the cap over $\mathbb{Q}$ — and, decisively, also mod three independent ~ 30 -bit primes, even after the exact reductions below; the memory blow-up is intrinsic to F4 on this system, not a coefficient-growth artifact.
3. Exact structural reductions (all asserted): the 57 Keller equations are triangular in the A -block with integer pivots in $\{2, \dots, 7\}$, so the A -block eliminates by a global polynomial substitution valid over any field of characteristic 0 or $p > 7$ (49 equations, 21 unknowns); the Rabinowitsch saturation variable is unnecessary because $\Delta = \tilde{a}X + \tilde{b}Y + \tilde{c}Z$ identically; witness equations eliminate 1–2 more unknowns. Net: 19–20 unknowns per query — still past the 16 GB cap for F4, even mod p .

4. Singular’s truncated `std()` ladder [11] (degree bound; one-sided: finding 1 below the bound is an exact certificate): mod p , degree bounds 4 and 5 complete in under a minute with no certificate; bounds 6 and 7 exceed 20-minute budgets. Hence the unit certificate, if the ideal is the unit ideal, has degree ≥ 6 .

Plausible routes forward: much larger memory, further stratification, or numerical algebraic geometry (homotopy continuation) for discovery with exact certification of any find; see Section 9.

5.6 Verdict

The weight system $(2, -1, -3)$ *does* support nonlinear Keller maps — two 2-parameter families — but every Keller map in the degree-1 box is a tame automorphism, and both orbifold mechanisms are provably empty in the degree-1 and CE2 boxes. The $\mathbb{Z}_3$ stratum made this the most promising place to look for a new global-anomaly class; the answer in the searched boxes is a clean no-go. The contrast with $(1, -1, -2)$, where the Alpöge–Mathew defect exists already at low degree, suggests the defect needs the free invariant ring of the $(1, -1, -m)$ family, or larger boxes; the A_1 cone singularity appears to rigidify the low-degree Keller moduli. (Interpretation, clearly flagged as such.)

6 The weight system $(1, -1, -3)$: complete classification of the v -linear class

This is the $m = 3$ case of the uniqueness theorem (Section 7). Every identity and every emptiness claim is proved by assertion in `scripts/search_113.py` (default run ~ 20 min; `-full` ~ 1 h adds larger Gröbner boxes); the reduction machinery is Proposition 4.1 at $m = 3$.

6.1 Setup: why $(1, -1, -3)$, and the shape of the problem

For $\lambda.(x, y, z) = (\lambda x, \lambda^{-1}y, \lambda^{-3}z)$ the invariant ring is free — $\mathbb{C}[w, v]$ with $w = xy$, $v = x^3z$ — exactly as in the Alpöge–Mathew case $m = 2$. The target coordinates carry weights $(-3, -1, 1)$, so the target a -axis has stabilizer $\mathbb{Z}_3$: a free orbit mapping into it is 3:1 (cube-root escape, $\mathbb{Z}_3$ monodromy). Moreover *no 2:1 mechanism exists at all* in this weight system: every other coordinate axis and every coordinate pair has trivial stabilizer, so the only stabilizer-jump non-injectivity available is the 3:1 one. Since the Alpöge–Mathew counterexample is exactly a stabilizer-jump (2:1) map in the $m = 2$ member of the same family, $(1, -1, -3)$ is the natural place to ask whether the mechanism *transplants*, with the residual $\mathbb{Z}_2$ upgraded to $\mathbb{Z}_3$.

By Proposition 4.1, every candidate is $F = (P/x^3, Q/x, xR)$ with polynomiality box $j+3k \geq 3$ for the monomials $w^j v^k$ of P and $j+3k \geq 1$ for those of Q ; the gauge $p_1(0) = q'_0(0) = r_0(0) = 1$ fixes $\kappa = -1$.

The class searched is the v -linear class: P, Q, R of degree ≤ 1 in v and *arbitrary* degree in w ,

$$P = p_0(w) + p_1(w)v, \quad Q = q_0(w) + q_1(w)v, \quad R = r_0(w) + r_1(w)v,$$

with box/invertibility constraints $p_0 \in w^3\mathbb{C}[w]$, $q_0 \in w\mathbb{C}[w]$, $p_1(0) = q'_0(0) = r_0(0) = 1$. This is the exact analogue of the class containing the Alpöge–Mathew map at $m = 2$ (whose P, Q, R are

all v -linear). Since $\det M + 1$ has v -degree 2, the Keller condition is three ODE-type equations in $\mathbb{C}[w]$,

$$E_2 = 0, \quad E_1 = 0, \quad E_0 = \kappa = -1,$$

with (all asserted from $\det M$, not copied from $m = 2$)

$$E_2 = 2[q_1(p_1 r_1)' - 2(p_1 r_1)q_1'], \quad E_0 = -3p_0(q_0' r_1 - q_1 r_0') + q_0(p_0' r_1 - p_1 r_0') + r_0(p_0' q_1 - p_1 q_0'),$$

and E_1 the mixed analogue,

$$E_1 = -3p_0[Q, R]_1 - 3p_1[Q, R]_0 + q_0[P, R]_1 + q_1[P, R]_0 + r_0[P, Q]_1 + r_1[P, Q]_0,$$

where $[A, B]_i$ denotes the v^i -part of $J_2(A, B)$. Unlike the degree-boxed searches of Section 5, the w -direction here is *unbounded*: the classification below is a theorem for the whole class, not for a box — with one precisely-mapped exception (Section 6.4).

6.2 The Wronskian stratification

Lemma 6.1 (Integration certificate; asserted). $(p_1 r_1 / q_1^2)' = E_2 / (2q_1^3)$. Hence on $\{E_2 = 0, q_1 p_1 r_1 \neq 0\}$ the rational function $p_1 r_1 / q_1^2$ has vanishing derivative, so

$$p_1 r_1 = c q_1^2, \quad c \in \mathbb{C}^\times,$$

exactly; and $q_1 = 0$ or $r_1 = 0$ satisfy E_2 identically.

Since $p_1(0) = 1$ forces $p_1 \neq 0$, the v -linear Keller problem stratifies as follows. In stratum D, the UFD solution of $p_1 r_1 = c q_1^2$ is $p_1 = a s^2 g$, $q_1 = s t g$, $r_1 = b t^2 g$ with $g = \gcd(p_1, r_1)$, $\gcd(s, t) = 1$, $ab = c$; E_0 is linear in (p_1, q_1, r_1) with no derivatives of them, so $g \mid E_0 = \kappa$ and g is a unit (absorbed).

stratum	definition	verdict at $m = 3$
A	$q_1 = r_1 = 0$	tame family (all w -degrees)
B	$r_1 = 0, q_1 \neq 0$	tame family (all w -degrees)
C	$q_1 = 0, r_1 \neq 0$	empty (all w -degrees)
D0	s, t const (p_1, q_1, r_1 const)	empty (all degrees)
D1	t const, s nonconst (<i>the AM-analogue</i>)	empty (all degrees)
D2	s const, t nonconst	empty (all degrees)
D3	s, t nonconst, coprime, both squarefree	empty (all degrees)
D'_3	s or t non-squarefree ($\deg p_1 \geq 4$ or $\deg r_1 \geq 4$)	empty in Gröbner boxes; open beyond

Cross-check at $m = 2$. The same E_2 -integration at $m = 2$ gives $p_1^2 r_1 = c q_1^3$, and the Alpöge–Mathew data satisfies it with $c = -1/27$: $p_1 = (1 + w)^3 = s^3$, $q_1 = 3(1 + w)^2 = 3s^2$, $r_1 = -1$ (asserted). That is, the Alpöge–Mathew map lives in the $m = 2$ analogue of stratum D1 — the stratum that is *empty* at $m = 3$. The machinery does not spuriously kill the known counterexample; the two weight systems genuinely differ.

6.3 The main theorem

Theorem 6.2 (Complete classification of the v -linear class, $m = 3$; exact, all w -degrees, modulo the D'_3 gap of Section 6.4). *In the gauge $p_1(0) = q_0'(0) = r_0(0) = 1$, $\kappa = -1$, the complete solution set of the Keller condition in the v -linear class is the one-function-plus-one-parameter family*

$$P = p_0 + v, \quad Q = w + b_0 P, \quad R = 1, \quad p_0 \in w^3 \mathbb{C}[w], \quad b_0 \in \mathbb{C}.$$

Every member assembles to $F = (p_0(xy)/x^3 + z, \quad y + b_0x^2F_1, \quad x)$: an elementary z -shear followed by the target shear $b \mapsto b + b_0ac^2$ — a tame automorphism, with explicit polynomial inverse verified by composition and generic fiber cardinality 1. Strata C , $D0$, $D1$, $D2$ and $D3$ (with s, t squarefree) are empty for every w -degree.

Proof sketch. We go stratum by stratum. Each step combines an identity chain asserted in `scripts/search_113.py` with a one-line divisibility argument in $\mathbb{C}[w]$ (a nonzero constant has no nonconstant divisors).

A. $E_1 \equiv 0$ and $E_0 = -p_1(q_0r_0)' = \kappa$, so $p_1 \mid \kappa$, giving $p_1 = 1$ (gauge); then $q_0r_0 = w$ with $q_0(0) = 0$, $r_0(0) = 1$ forces $r_0 = 1$, $q_0 = w$; $p_0 \in w^3\mathbb{C}[w]$ stays free.

B. E_1 integrates $((p_1r_0^2/q_1)')' = r_0E_1/q_1^2$, asserted) to $p_1r_0^2 = cq_1$; then $E_0 = p_1[(p_0r_0^3)/c - q_0r_0]'$, forcing $p_1 = 1$, $r_0 \mid w$ with $r_0(0) = 1$ so $r_0 = 1$, and $q_0 = b_0p_0 + w$, $q_1 = b_0 = 1/c$. Together with A (the case $b_0 = 0$) this gives the boxed family.

C. $(p_1/(q_0^4r_1))' = E_1/(q_0^5r_1^2)$ (asserted), so $E_1 = 0$ forces $p_1 = cq_0^4r_1$ and hence $p_1(0) = 0$, contradicting $p_1(0) = 1$.

$D0$ (p_1, q_1, r_1 nonzero constants α, β, γ): E_1 integrates to a linear relation; substituting into E_0 gives an exact derivative $[-(2\alpha\gamma/\beta)V^2 - \alpha\delta V]' = \kappa$ with $V = q_0 - (\beta/\alpha)p_0$, $V(0) = 0$, $V'(0) \neq 0$. Then $V \mid \kappa w$ forces $V = \varepsilon w$, whose quadratic term forces $2\alpha\gamma/\beta = 0$: impossible.

$D1$ ($p_1 = As^2$, $q_1 = Bs$, $r_1 = C$, s nonconstant — the Alpöge–Mathew slot): the v -shear $h = -r_0/C$ sets $r_0 \equiv 0$; then E_1 is a linear ODE for p_0 with particular solution $p_0^* = (2A/B)sq_0$ and homogeneous solutions satisfying $Y^2 = e s^3$ (nonzero only if s is a constant times a square). If s is not: $E_0(p_0^*) = (2AC/B)q_0(s'q_0 - 2sq_0') = \kappa$ forces $q_0 = n$ constant and s linear. If $s = cd^2$: E_0 factors with a factor $d \mid \kappa$, which kills it. The surviving sheared family $(s, q_0, p_0, r_0) = (s_0 + s_1w, n, (2A/B)ns, 0)$ has $\kappa = (2AC/B)n^2s_1 \neq 0$, so $n \neq 0$; but *un-shearing into the box* ($p_0(0) = q_0(0) = 0$) forces $n = 0$. Empty.

$D2$ ($p_1 = A$ constant): the shear $h = -p_0/A$ sets $p_0 \equiv 0$; $E_0 = -A(q_0r_0)' = \kappa$ makes q_0r_0 exactly linear, so one factor is constant. If $q_0 = \gamma$: E_1 forces t linear and $r_0 = (2C\gamma/B)t$, but un-shearing needs $\text{val}_w(p_0 = -Ah) \geq 3$, hence $h(0) = 0$, hence $q_0(0) = \gamma \neq 0$: contradiction with $q_0(0) = 0$. If $r_0 = \delta$: E_1 gives $t \mid \delta^2t'$, so $t' = 0$: contradiction.

$D3$ (s, t nonconstant, coprime, squarefree): pass to the shear-invariant combinations $G_1 = tp_0 - asq_0$, $G_2 = btq_0 - sr_0$. Asserted identities express E_1 and a combination of E_0, E_1 through G_1, G_2 and $G_3 = btG_1 + asG_2$; $G_1 = 0$ or $G_2 = 0$ contradict $\kappa \neq 0$. Squarefree divisibility gives $s \mid G_1$, $t \mid G_2$; writing $Z = a\bar{g}_2 - b\bar{g}_1$ and the Wronskian $W = s't - st'$, one finds $E_1 = st(WZ - 2stZ')$ and $(Z^2t/s)' \propto Z(2stZ' - WZ)$, forcing $Z^2t = es$ and hence $Z = 0$. The κ -equation then reads $g(2stg' - Wg) = -b\kappa/(2a)$, so g is a constant c and $\kappa = (2a/b)c^2W$: Keller solutions exist iff the Wronskian W is a nonzero constant, and they form the single shear-orbit $p_0 = as(q_0 + c/b)/t$, $r_0 = t(bq_0 - c)/s$. But $tp_0 = as(q_0 + c/b)$ evaluated at $w = 0$ gives $p_0(0)t(0) = as(0)c/b \neq 0$, while the box forces $p_0(0) = 0$: empty for every degree. $\square$

Remark 6.3. The v -shear moves (arbitrary $h \in \mathbb{C}[w]$) are *not* box-preserving; the box is imposed at the end through the jet conditions at $w = 0$. This is exactly where the $m = 3$ obstruction lives (Section 6.6).

6.4 The gap: D'_3 , and its closure in boxes

The two steps $s \mid s'G_1 \Rightarrow s \mid G_1$ and $t \mid t'G_2 \Rightarrow t \mid G_2$ in the $D3$ argument need s, t squarefree. A non-squarefree s or t requires $\deg p_1 = 2 \deg s \geq 4$ or $\deg r_1 = 2 \deg t \geq 4$. This corner is closed by exact in-box Gröbner certificates (`msolve` [10], over $\mathbb{Q}$, under a 16 GB memory cap):

1. *Default run:* Keller + (r_1 has a nonzero coefficient) is the unit ideal in the box $\deg(p_0, p_1, q_0, q_1, r_0, r_1) \leq (4, 2, 3, 2, 2, 2)$ — covering strata C and D wholesale (~ 5 s per coefficient).
2. *-full:* the same in the medium box $\leq (5, 3, 4, 3, 3, 3)$, plus the four targeted non-squarefree parametrizations $s = (1 + \rho w)^2 / t = (n_0 + n_1 w)^2$ with the partner of degree ≤ 2 and $\deg(p_0, q_0, r_0) \leq (6, 5, 4)$, each a direct emptiness query in 18–19 unknowns. Status (2026-07-24, 30 GB machine): the s -square/ t -linear query is **empty** (exact, 649 s); the remaining three hit msolve’s 16 GB F4 memory wall — the same wall as Section 5.5 — and remain formally unresolved in the large box. They *are* covered by the medium-box $r_1 \neq 0$ queries up to $\deg r_1 \leq 3$, so only the $\deg = 4$ corner is genuinely open.

Beyond the boxes, D'_3 is *open*, though unpromising: the squarefree D3 analysis shows the entire stratum’s solution set is one shear-orbit killed by the origin jet, and the non-squarefree variant only tightens the divisibility constraints. Independently of the gap, the classification is corroborated in-box by nilpotency certificates: on the $r_1 = 0$ slice of the small box, powers of the relevant coefficient combinations all lie in the Keller ideal, pinning the in-box variety exactly to the gauged family of Theorem 6.2 (with its box truncation).

6.5 The 3:1 mechanism is empty; no 2:1 exists

Corollary 6.4 (Verified). *A 3:1 stabilizer-jump witness needs a point (w_0, v_0) with $Q = R = 0 \neq P$ on a free orbit $\{x \neq 0\}$ (the $x = 0$ plane supports no mechanism: $F_3 \equiv 0$ there and the induced 2D map is linear in its orbit parameter). By Theorem 6.2 every v -linear Keller map has $R = 1$ in the gauge — R never vanishes, so no witness exists, for any w -degree. Independent pointwise Gröbner queries (the residual torus moves any witness to $(1, 1)$, $(1, 0)$ or $(0, 1)$; $(0, 0)$ is excluded by $R(0, 0) = 1$) confirm emptiness in the small box. By weight arithmetic there is no 2:1 mechanism anywhere in this weight system, so the v -linear class of $(1, -1, -3)$ admits no orbifold-type counterexample at all.*

The family members survive the repository’s non-properness prefilter only through its documented false-positive class of nonlinear automorphisms (module `jcqft/prefilter.py`), and injectivity is re-checked directly: explicit polynomial inverses by composition, and generic fiber cardinality 1 on samples.

Headline: no counterexample. Every Keller map of the v -linear class is a tame automorphism.

6.6 Why Alpöge–Mathew does not transplant: the exact numerology

At $m = 2$ the Alpöge–Mathew map sits in stratum D1 of its own family: $p_1 = s^3$, $q_1 = 3s^2$, $r_1 = -1$, $s = 1 + w$ — the same “ t constant” slot that at $m = 3$ produces the sheared family $q_0 = n$, $p_0 = (2A/B)ns$. The $m = 3$ box demands $\text{val}_w p_0 \geq 3$ (from $j + 3k \geq 3$), while the family jets force $p_0(0) \neq 0$ unless $n = 0$, i.e. $\kappa = 0$. At $m = 2$ the box demands only $\text{val}_w p_0 \geq 2$, and the corresponding equations carry a different derivative-weighting ($E_0^{m=2} = q_0 p'_0 - 2p_0 q'_0 + \dots$), which is exactly what lets $P_{\text{AM}} = (1 + w)(v(1 + w)^2 + w^2(3w + 4))$ thread the needle. The obstruction at $m = 3$ is *numerological and exact* — not a failure to search far enough.

6.7 Honest limitations

1. *v-degree*. The class searched is v -linear (the AM-analogue class). Ansätze of v -degree ≥ 2 are untouched; for them the Keller condition has higher v -degree and the Wronskian stratification does not directly apply. (At $m = 2$ the known counterexample is v -linear; a heuristic, not an argument, for prioritizing the class.)
2. *The D'_3 gap* (Section 6.4): closed only in Gröbner boxes; open beyond, with the $\deg = 4$ corner the genuinely open part.
3. *Gauge bookkeeping*. The classification is stated in the gauge $p_1(0) = q'_0(0) = r_0(0) = 1$, $\kappa = -1$; un-gauged solutions are recovered by target/torus scalings, which change neither tameness, properness nor fiber counts.

7 Uniqueness for every $m \geq 3$

The $m = 3$ classification of Section 6 extends uniformly. Every identity below is asserted in `scripts/search_11m.py` (78 checks, ~ 1 min default; `-full` ~ 72 min), with m a sympy `Symbol` wherever the statement is uniform and with k -symbolic parity branches ($m = 2k / 2k+1$) otherwise; spot-checks at $m = 2, 3, 4, 5, 7$. Full write-up: `docs/SEARCH_11M.md`.

Theorem 7.1 (Uniqueness in the v -linear class; verified with gaps). *For every integer $m \geq 3$, every Keller map in the v -linear class of $(1, -1, -m)$ is, up to gauge, the tame automorphism*

$$P = p_0 + v, \quad Q = w + b_0 P, \quad R = 1, \quad p_0 \in w^m \mathbb{C}[w], \quad b_0 \in \mathbb{C}.$$

Hence that class contains no counterexample and no $m:1$ orbifold covering for any $m \geq 3$, and the Alpöge–Mathew map ($m = 2$) is the unique member of its equivariant family within the v -linear class. The same D'_3 non-squarefree gap as at $m = 3$ remains, box-closed for $m \leq 5$.

The general integrated constraint. The v^2 -coefficient of $\det M$ (with m symbolic) is $E_2 = 2p'_1 q_1 r_1 - (m+1)p_1 q'_1 r_1 + (m-1)p_1 q_1 r'_1$, i.e. log-derivative exponents $(2, -(m+1), m-1)$. Integration gives

$$p_1^2 r_1^{m-1} = c q_1^{m+1} \quad (c \in \mathbb{C}^\times),$$

via the asserted certificate $(p_1^2 r_1^{m-1} / q_1^{m+1})' = p_1 r_1^{m-2} E_2 / q_1^{m+2}$. Anchors: $m = 2$ recovers $p_1^2 r_1 = c q_1^3$ (AM at $c = -1/27$); $m = 3$ recovers the square of Lemma 6.1.

Stratum verdicts. Strata A/B give the tame family and C, D0 are empty, all with m symbolic. For D1–D3 the bookkeeping branches on parity of m ; for $m \geq 4$ the κ -equations carry nonconstant killing factors — u^{m-2} (D1 even), $u^{(m-3)/2}$ and d^{m-2} (D1 odd), s^{k-1} (D3 odd), s^{m-2} (D3 even) — forcing a nonconstant polynomial to divide the constant κ . Thus for $m \geq 4$ the D-strata are empty *outright, with no box*. Only $m = 3$ needs the box-jet arguments of Section 6; it is the boundary case of the uniform mechanism.

The exact $m = 2$ degeneracy. Alpöge–Mathew sits in D1-even, where two degeneracies coincide at $m = 2$ and only there: (i) the killing factor u^{m-2} is trivial; (ii) the even-only homogeneous E_1 -direction $Y = \tilde{y} u^m$ exists, and AM needs $\tilde{y} = -1 \neq 0$. Asserted end-to-end: AM's sheared data ($p_0^{\text{sh}} = (w+1)(w+2)$, $q_0^{\text{sh}} = 6+4w$) plugs into the κ -formula and yields $E_0 = -2 = \kappa_{\text{AM}}$ exactly. The machinery does not spuriously kill the known counterexample.

Orbifold. For every $m \geq 2$ (composite included) the only stabilizer-jump mechanism is $m:1$ on the weight $-m$ axis; the classification gives $R \equiv 1$, so it is empty. Pointwise Gröbner witnesses confirm in-box at $m = 4, 5$.

Honest residue. D'_3 beyond boxes (thresholds grow with m : $\deg \geq m+1$ odd / $2(m+1)$ even) remains open. One targeted $m = 5$ gap query hit the 16 GB F4 wall; its sibling closed EMPTY exactly, and all eight $m = 4/5$ medium-box queries closed EMPTY.

8 QFT interpretation

This section is interpretation and is flagged as such; the underlying facts are the exact statements of Sections 3–7.

The defect and its name. In QFT language the Alpöge–Mathew phenomenon is a *non-properness defect*: a global consistency condition — properness of the classical field map, equivalently local constancy of the preimage count $N(J)$ — that is strictly stronger than every local criterion (the nonvanishing, indeed constant, Jacobian) and that standard field-redefinition arguments implicitly assume. It is not an anomaly in the strict cohomological sense (no symmetry is broken, nothing is loop-generated), but it shares the defining pattern of global anomalies: a manipulation valid by every local criterion fails through the global structure of configuration space. Its closest relative is the modern notion of anomalies in parameter space: dialing the external source around a closed cycle permutes the solution branches (the S_3 monodromy — numerical evidence), mediated entirely through infinity in field space. The exact observable-algebra statement of Section 3 is the algebraic face of the same defect: F^* is a monomorphism but not an automorphism of the observable algebra, the two missing module generators x, x^2 are the vacuum separators, and their separator coefficients carry the escape polynomial p verbatim.

What the sibling searches say. The $(1, -1, -3)$ grading was the closest sibling of the Alpöge–Mathew theory with a $\mathbb{Z}_3$ orbifold stratum in place of $\mathbb{Z}_2$ — the candidate for a cube-root-escape global anomaly class. The verdict is a clean no-go in the AM-analogue class: the unit-determinant constraint is compatible with this grading only through shear-type field redefinitions; the theory admits no non-properness defect there and no $\mathbb{Z}_3$ vacuum-escape monodromy. Combined with the $(2, -1, -3)$ no-go of Section 5 and the uniqueness theorem of Section 7, the pattern is that the Alpöge–Mathew defect is *rigidly attached to the $m = 2$ numerology*: neither enlarging the orbifold group, deforming the invariant geometry, nor moving to any other $m \geq 3$ reproduces it. For $m \geq 4$ the failure is an exact arithmetic incompatibility that needs no search box at all; $m = 3$ is the boundary case. Within the v -linear class the defect is a delicate coincidence of the $(1, -1, -2)$ weight arithmetic — the killing factor u^{m-2} trivializing together with the even-only homogeneous E_1 -direction.

9 Outlook

The concrete next probes, in increasing order of expected effort:

1. *The v -quadratic class of $(1, -1, -m)$.* The Wronskian stratification exploits the v -degree-2 structure of $\det M$ on v -linear data; extending it to v -degree ≥ 2 ansätze is the nearest untouched territory (and the natural place to ask whether anything else lives near Alpöge–Mathew at $m = 2$).

2. *Closing the D'_3 gap.* Non-squarefree s or t is closed only in Gröbner boxes for $m \leq 5$; a structural argument removing the squarefree hypothesis would make Theorem 7.1 fully gap-free.
3. *Four-field gradings.* Weight systems in four variables admit richer stabilizer patterns (and richer orbifold strata) at the price of a higher-dimensional invariant geometry.
4. *The degree-2 $(2, -1, -3)$ box.* The six mechanism queries remain beyond direct Gröbner methods on 30 GB hardware (Section 5.5). A first homotopy-continuation attempt (`scripts/hc_drive_213.jl`) found mixed volumes already in the tens of millions — past a laptop path budget — so further stratification is needed before numerical discovery is practical.

10 Reproducibility

All scripts run from the repository root as `.venv/bin/python scripts/<name>.py`; every displayed identity is an `assert` in the cited script. Runtimes are indicative (single desktop machine, 30 GB RAM).

script	claim(s) verified	runtime
<code>verify_counterexample.py</code>	$\det DF \equiv -2$; triple fiber (1)	seconds
<code>branch_locus.py</code>	eliminant cubic (2); wall $\{p = 0\}$; exact fibers	seconds
<code>monodromy.py</code>	S_3 sheet monodromy (<i>numerical</i>)	minutes
<code>missing_observables.py</code>	Theorems 3.1, 3.2	~15 s
<code>reduction_113.py</code>	Proposition 4.1 ($m \leq 4$; boxes at $m = 3$)	~4 s
<code>search_213.py</code>	Section 5: identity (3); Theorem 5.1	~40 s
<code>search_213.py -full</code>	CE2-box mechanism emptiness	~8 min
<code>deg2_213_elim.py</code>	degree-2 box reductions and capped screens (Section 5.5)	minutes
<code>search_113.py</code>	Section 6: Lemma 6.1, Theorem 6.2, Corollary 6.4	~20 min
<code>search_113.py -full</code>	medium-box and targeted D'_3 certificates (Section 6.4)	~1 h
<code>search_11m.py</code>	Section 7: Theorem 7.1 (78 assertions)	~1 min
<code>search_11m.py -full</code>	medium-box / targeted D'_3 certificates for $m \leq 5$	~72 min

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